MATTHEW BLAIR-VINCENT

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Cybersecurity Portfolio: github.com/matthew-blair-vincent

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

CompTIA Security+ certified cybersecurity professional and former Parachute Regiment soldier transitioning into an entry-level role in Security Operations (SOC), Threat Intelligence, or Incident Response. Strong grounding in the intelligence lifecycle, threat analysis, and adversary behaviour developed through operational military intelligence, reconnaissance, and investigative work.

CORE SKILLS

Cybersecurity Certifications & Training

- **CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701)** - Certified
- Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate
- Immersive Labs – hands-on SOC labs covering log analysis, threat detection, incident response, and security investigations
- TryHackMe (log analysis, Wireshark, phishing analysis.

Security Operations (SOC)

- Log analysis and alert triage
- Threat detection and incident reporting
- **SIEM** investigation workflows (training labs)
- Threat hunting concepts based on TTPs and behavioural indicators

Threat & Risk Analysis

- **Intelligence lifecycle** (collection, analysis, dissemination)
- **OSINT** and **HUMINT** methodologies transferable to cyber threat intelligence
- Pattern recognition and adversary behaviour analysis

Information Assurance

- MOD Defence Information Management Passport & Protecting Information
- Secure handling of classified and sensitive data
- GDPR and data protection awareness

Leadership & Communication

- Qualified instructor (BTEC L3 Education & Training, ILM Team Leading)
- Intelligence briefings and written reporting for decision-makers

Languages

- English (native)
- French (fluent

TECHNICAL TOOLS

Wireshark | Linux CLI | Log Analysis | SIEM Concepts | Threat Intelligence Frameworks | OSINT Techniques | Network Fundamentals | Phishing Analysis

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Royal Artillery Reserves | Present

British Army

- Support unit training and exercises while maintaining readiness and discipline.
- Apply analytical and leadership skills gained from previous intelligence and reconnaissance roles.
- Continue professional development with focus on cyber readiness.

Parachute Regiment – Reconnaissance & Tactical Intelligence | 2007-2016

British Army

- **Herrick 8:** Rifleman on frontline operations in Afghanistan.
- **Herrick 13:** Intelligence Cell – produced reports, briefings, and risk assessments to support operational planning.
- Completed **Tactical Intelligence Course (TIC Alpha)** before deployment – trained in information collection, pattern analysis, mapping, and report writing under operational conditions.
- Collected and analysed intelligence from multiple sources, identifying patterns of insurgent activity.
- Conducted reconnaissance patrols and HUMINT collection in Patrols Platoon (3 PARA), applying observation, pattern recognition, and threat identification skills directly transferable to cyber threat hunting and adversary behaviour analysis.
- Promoted to Lance Corporal; trained, mentored and lead junior soldiers as a patrol commander
- Completed specialist training: Tactical Intelligence (Afghanistan-specific), Ground Sign Awareness Instructor.
- Awarded the Operational Service Medal (Afghanistan with clasp).

Endangered Species Protection Agency (ESPA), DRC & South Africa | 2016–2020

Endangered Species Protection Agency

- Delivered anti-poaching training to ranger units in French across the DRC, covering tactics, awareness, and operational resilience.
- Conducted **privately commissioned investigative work** in South Africa on illegal wildlife trafficking networks — primarily a journalistic project using HUMINT and OSINT techniques to document trafficking routes and key actors. Liaised with partners such as the **South African SPCA** for welfare-related interventions.
- Produced reports and briefings to support awareness campaigns and conservation stakeholders.
- Enhanced local ranger capacity and built strong cross-cultural training partnerships.

Sea Company – Founder & Coordinator | 2021–Present

South Shields Surf School

- Founded a veterans' surf therapy group in partnership with South Shields Surf School.
- Expanded membership to circa 100 veterans, with weekly surf and beach-based sessions.
- Secured £25,000 grant from the Veterans' Foundation to expand operations and outreach. Designed and delivered free surf lessons, peer-led recovery activities, and community integration programmes for veterans facing PTSD, depression, and social isolation.
- Built a self-sustaining culture of resilience and leadership among participants.

Oceander CIC – Co-Founder & Chief Security Officer | 2022–Present

Oceander CIC

- Co-founded a social enterprise providing accommodation and support for homeless people and vulnerable individuals.
- Oversaw safeguarding, compliance, and GDPR processes to ensure secure handling of sensitive client data.
- Leading the organisation through the **Cyber Essentials Plus certification process**, improving IT governance, endpoint protection, and access controls
- Managing and advising on the **SOC, IT and network installation** for the new facility.
- Built partnerships with councils, charities, and community organisations to expand support networks.
- Manage budgets, recruitment, and operational risk.

Property Business – Owner/Manager | 2020–Present

Springtide Property Ltd

- Manage buy-to-let property portfolio and tenancy agreements.
- Oversee contracts, finance, and secure digital documentation.

CLEARANCES AND QUALIFICATIONS

- **Security Clearance: Active Security Check (SC), Counter-Terrorist Check (CTC) and NATO Secret –** current through Army Reserve service.
- **MOD Information Assurance Training** – Defence Information Management Passport & Protecting Information (secure handling of classified/sensitive data).
- Tactical Intelligence (Theatre-Specific, Afghanistan) – intelligence collection, analysis, and reporting.
- Ground Sign Awareness Instructor (2015) – advanced tracking and pattern recognition.
- **Combat Infantryman (PARA), Reconnaissance (LRCC)** and **2IC Section Commander.**
- BTEC Level 3 Award in Education & Training (2018) – qualified instructor.
- BCS Level 2 Certificate in IT User Skills (ECDL Extra, 2016).
- ILM Level 2 Award in Team Leading (2010).
- OCR Level 2 Certificates in Adult Literacy & Numeracy.
- Operational Service Medal (Afghanistan, with clasp).

TRAINING & EDUCATION (REFINED)

- CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) – Certified
- Immersive Labs (Ongoing): Hands-on SOC and incident response labs (suspicious email analysis, registry key hunts, malware detection, digital forensics).
- Google Cybersecurity Professional Certification, Core cyber foundations including networking, Linux CLI, security operations, and incident response.
- TryHackMe: Practical labs in log analysis, Wireshark filtering, suspicious email analysis, and basic penetration testing.
- **Technical Exposure:** Linux CLI, networking fundamentals, phishing analysis, SIEM concepts, digital forensics basics.